

Saber Ayatollahi, CFA, MSc

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SUMMARY

VP, Portfolio Management, Investing & Oversight candidate with ~7 years bridging institutional investment teams, technology, and risk & governance functions on enterprise portfolio and analytics platforms. Led client onboarding and the legacy Calypso migration to the PFaroe PM platform for all assigned accounts; serves on Moody's model governance committee covering methodology review, documentation, and benchmarking standards. Holds delegated sign-off on valuation, sensitivity, and portfolio-level analytics for institutional portfolios of \$5-25bn per engagement. CFA charterholder; dual MSc in Financial Modelling and Chemical Engineering.

CORE SKILLS

Investment & Portfolio Platform Delivery • Model Governance, Approvals & Documentation Standards • Portfolio Construction & Asset Allocation Analytics • Portfolio Risk, Sensitivity & Diagnostics Reporting • Auditability, Logging & Process Controls • Exception Escalation & Resolution Workflows • Cross-Functional Delivery (Investments, Technology, Risk, Finance/Actuarial) • Requirements Scoping & Product Owner Partnership • Executive & Investment-Committee Stakeholder Management

EXPERIENCE

Moody's Analytics

Asst. Director - Modelling Services

Toronto, May 2023 - Present

Model Governance & Oversight

- Hold delegated sign-off authority on valuation, sensitivity, and portfolio analytics delivered to multi-asset institutional client portfolios of \$5-25bn per engagement (~\$50bn+ cumulative), independently reviewing curve construction, spread calibration, and cross-asset interactions before production release.
- Serve on the model governance committee covering methodology review, documentation and benchmarking standards, and model-performance assessment for client-delivered analytics.
- Escalate outputs lacking mathematical or economic defensibility and act as escalation point for client-critical analytical issues, interfacing directly with clients' Heads of Risk and investment stakeholders.

Portfolio Analytics, Insights & Client Reporting

- Review aggregation logic converting security-level exposures into portfolio-level risk and sensitivity metrics feeding downstream reporting and capital processes.
- Validate derivatives pricing outputs across rates, FX, and inflation, and oversee duration and sensitivity analytics to ensure consistency of risk metrics at portfolio-level aggregates.
- Prepare analytical summaries for senior stakeholders on portfolio exposure, scenario impacts, and portfolio sensitivities, translating quantitative output into committee-ready narratives.

Platform Modernization & Operational Efficiency

- Led design and implementation of an enterprise multi-asset cash flow projection engine supporting base, stress, and reverse-stress scenarios, with configurable time-bucketed analytics from T+1 through multi-year horizons.
- Re-engineered manual spreadsheet workflows into scalable Python analytics pipelines with embedded logging, validation, and auditability controls, closing a model-governance audit finding.
- Built agentic AI development workflows (Claude Code, Cursor IDE) automating code generation, validation scaffolding, and documentation, reducing development cycle time an estimated 30-40% on comparable modules.

Client Service Specialist

Toronto, May 2022 - May 2023

- Led onboarding and implementation for U.S. and Canadian pension funds, asset managers, and consulting firms adopting the PFaroe DB (risk analytics) and PFaroe PM (portfolio management) platforms.

- Served as technical liaison between client investment teams and product owners: advised on portfolio, asset, and liability configuration, scoped requirements into PO development requests, and validated model outputs post-deployment.
- Migrated all assigned client accounts off the legacy Calypso environment onto the PFaroe PM platform, with configuration patterns reused across the subsequent migration cohort.

Ernst & Young (EY)

Senior Consultant - Financial Risk Transformation

Toronto, Sep 2021 - Apr 2022

- Delivered IFRS 17 and IFRS 9 technology-transformation projects for Canadian and international insurance clients, aligning regulatory requirements with system implementation and reporting frameworks.
- Coordinated actuarial, finance, IT, risk, and program-management teams on milestone delivery, and contributed to governance documentation and regulatory-readiness processes.

Ortec Finance Canada

Consultant - Asset-Liability Management & Risk

Toronto, Feb 2019 - Sep 2021

- Advised institutional clients on Strategic Asset Allocation (SAA) and Tactical Asset Allocation (TAA) trade-offs through stress testing and sensitivity analysis, informing portfolio construction and duration positioning decisions.
- Performed asset-only and asset-liability (surplus) portfolio optimization on VaR and CVaR using Ortec's GLASS platform, with risk decomposition, attribution, and near-optimal frontier analysis to test allocation robustness.
- Built and interpreted stochastic economic scenario generators assessing funding-ratio volatility and interest-rate risk under base-case and stressed environments for pension and institutional mandates.
- Presented study findings and allocation recommendations on-site to investment committees at Canadian pension-fund clients, including a three-plan university pension merger delivered on a team of three.

EDUCATION & CREDENTIALS

- Chartered Financial Analyst (CFA) - CFA Institute, 2024
- MSc, Financial Modelling - Western University, 2018
- MSc, Chemical Engineering (Full Scholarship) - Western University, 2016